

Bahawalpur

Complete Tourism Content

Website / App Reference • INSIDE_CITY • DAY_TRIP • CHOLISTAN • DHA_MODERN_CITY

Purpose	Structured tourism content for website/app use, route planning, attraction metadata, and future tourism database integration.
Ticket rule	A price is shown only where a specific figure was found in the source material. Otherwise, the content deliberately says “verify before visit”. Missing price does not mean free entry.
Source basis	TDCP Cholistan brochure; TDCP Bahawalpur City / Attractions-Around brochure; paragraph-form reference PDF; selected external cross-checks for Derawar Fort and Noor Mahal.

Prepared as a clean, publication-ready content reference.

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Bahawalpur — City of the Nawabs

Bahawalpur was founded in 1748 AD by Nawab Bahawal Khan I on the site of an earlier settlement, becoming the capital of a new state carved out by the Daudpotra tribe after their migration from Shikarpur, Sindh. The tribe's earlier base was near Derawar Fort in the Cholistan desert, and the ruling family kept that desert connection even after the capital moved to the banks of the Sutlej. The modern State of Bahawalpur was reaffirmed in 1802 under Nawab Muhammad Bahawal Khan II, and the Abbasi dynasty ruled for over 250 years — nine Nawabs in total — until the state acceded to Pakistan at independence in 1947 and formally merged into the country on 14 October 1955. The family promoted an Arab identity for the state, naming the capital "Baghdadul-Jadeed" and issuing the State's first postage stamps in Arabic and English script in January 1945. The local language is Saraiki, and the region's Sufi tradition — centred on scholars from Uch Sharif and the poet-philosopher Khawaja Ghulam Fareed — remains central to its cultural identity, alongside the desert's agni (fire) dance, mirror-work embroidery (gota), camel-skin crafts, and lacquered woodwork.

INSIDE_CITY — Bahawalpur Sightseeing Route

Double-decker bus loop, starting and ending at the TDCP Terminal, Stadium Road, Bahawalpur (Ph: 062-2501932).

Noor Mahal

Type: Palace / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** Yes — main palace stop | **Ticket:** Verify current gate tariff

Noor Mahal is Bahawalpur's best-known Nawabi-era palace, built between 1872 and 1875 by Nawab Sadiq Muhammad Khan IV — known as the "Shah Jahan of Bahawalpur" for his passion for architecture — as a residence for his wife. It was designed by the British state engineer Mr. Heenan in an Italian-chateau style on neoclassical lines, blending Corinthian columns with Islamic domes; the construction cost roughly Rs 1.2 million, an enormous sum at the time, with much of the material and furniture imported from England and Italy. According to local tradition, the Nawab's wife stayed there only a single night after noticing the nearby Basti Maluk graveyard from her balcony and refusing to return. The palace passed through various uses — royal guest house, state court, later a period under Pakistan Army stewardship — and today stands as a protected heritage landmark and the principal visitor attraction in the city. It should be presented as the main palace stop on any sightseeing route; publish an entry price only after confirming it directly with site management, since online figures go stale.

Darbar Mahal

Type: Royal Palace | **Double-Decker:** Exterior/route context only | **Ticket:** No public ticket; access must be verified

Darbar Mahal was completed around 1904–1907 by Nawab Muhammad Bahawal Khan Abbasi V as a palace for private and public audiences — a symmetrical building with octagonal corner rooms, stairways to a roof terrace, and Mughal-inspired domes, set within roughly 75 acres. Unlike Noor Mahal, it should not be marketed as a guaranteed interior visit: available sources describe it as currently under military control and not generally open to the public. Use it as a heritage-context or exterior-view point on your platform unless current permission is confirmed by TDCP or the relevant authority.

Gulzar Mahal

Type: Royal Palace | **Double-Decker:** Exterior/route context | **Ticket:** No reliable current public tariff

Gulzar Mahal, part of the same royal palace cluster, was built in 1904–1907 during the reign of Nawab Muhammad Bahawal Khan V, combining classical columns and a balustraded parapet with a mirror-mosaic ceiling; it sits within a 34-acre walled compound and was used both for public functions and as a state guest house. Historical accounts also note its early, concealed electrical wiring — notable for the period. Because public access can be restricted, verify current permission before presenting an interior tour.

Nishat Mahal

Type: Royal Palace | **Double-Decker:** No guaranteed interior visit | **Ticket:** Verify permission

Nishat Mahal is another historic component of Bahawalpur's royal palace complex, belonging to the same wave of Nawabi architectural development as Darbar Mahal, Gulzar Mahal and Farrukh Mahal. Its main tourism value is explanatory — it helps visitors understand that Bahawalpur's "royal heritage" was really a cluster of purpose-specific palaces rather than a single building. Treat public access as restricted and verification-required rather than assumed.

Farrukh Mahal

Type: Royal Palace | **Double-Decker:** Exterior/context only | **Ticket:** Verify permission

Farrukh Mahal completes the royal palace cluster alongside Darbar, Gulzar and Nishat Mahal. Like the others, its value for tourism is primarily architectural and historical rather than as an open interior attraction — confirm current visitor access before listing it as a stop on any route.

Sadiq Public School

Type: Educational Institution / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** Route context | **Ticket:** Functioning school — visits by arrangement only

The earth-breaking ceremony for Sadiq Public School took place in 1950 under Nawab Sadiq Muhammad Khan V, with regular classes beginning in 1954; its mosque was designed on the model of the mosque at Aitchison College, Lahore. It remains a prestigious institution with alumni across many professional fields. As a working school campus, it belongs on the route as a heritage point rather than a general-admission attraction — any visit needs prior arrangement.

Central Library Bahawalpur

Type: Education / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** Yes | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket identified

The Central Library's foundation stone was laid on 3 March 1924 by the Governor and Viceroy of India, Lord Reading (Sir Rufus Isaacs), to mark the installation of the last Nawab, Sir Sadiq Muhammad Khan Abbasi V. Its architecture reflects Bahawalpur's late-colonial/Nawabi-era civic development, and its ongoing library function makes it especially relevant to educational tourism. Present it as a short heritage or educational stop rather than a long visit.

The Bahawal Stadium

Type: Sports / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** Route context | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket

Locally known as Dring Stadium, this multi-purpose ground with a covered swimming pool holds the distinction of being Pakistan's first cricket ground — it hosted the second Test of India's inaugural tour of Pakistan in the 1954–55 season.

Bahawalpur Zoo

Type: Wildlife / Family | **Double-Decker:** Yes | **Ticket:** Government tariff currently lists Adult Rs 50, Child Rs 30, Student Rs 20 — verify before trip

Bahawalpur Zoo began life as "Sher Bagh" in the early 1940s before being formally established as a public zoo in 1942 under Nawab Sadiq Muhammad Khan V; it now spans roughly 25 acres with around 200 animals and 100 birds, a lion-breeding programme that supplies other parts of the country, and an aquarium plus zoological museum with taxidermy specimens. It works especially well as a supervised biodiversity and animal-observation stop for school groups. The Punjab Wildlife & Parks Department currently publishes the adult/child/student tariff above, but recheck the gate price before any live booking — departmental tariffs do change.

Jamia Masjid Al-Sadiq

Type: Mosque / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** Coach approach; walking visit | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket

Built in white marble with fine decorative work by Nawab Sir Sadiq Muhammad Khan Abbasi V, this mosque can hold around 50,000 worshippers during Eid. Its light façade, large courtyard, arches and minarets reflect Bahawalpur's architectural heritage. Present it as a religious site, not a standard ticketed attraction — visitor behaviour should follow mosque rules, prayer timings and local instructions.

Bahawalpur Museum

Type: Museum / Education | **Double-Decker:** Yes | **Ticket:** Current authoritative tariff should be verified before publishing

Bahawalpur Museum presents the history, archaeology, art and cultural heritage of both the city and the wider Cholistan region — coins, medals, postage stamps of the former State, manuscripts, documents, inscriptions, wood carvings, camel-skin paintings, historical models and stone carvings. It is one of the strongest educational stops on the sightseeing circuit, particularly useful for school trips that want to connect the Nawabi period and regional archaeology to physical collections.

Bahawalpur Railway Station

Type: Heritage / Transport | **Double-Decker:** Drive-by; access depends on traffic | **Ticket:** No sightseeing entry ticket

A historic transport landmark with distinctive colonial-era architecture, useful on the tourism website as an optional heritage point for visitors interested in architecture and railway history. It remains primarily a functioning railway facility rather than a conventional tourist attraction, so treat it as a drive-by point.

Old City Gates — Fareed Gate, Ahmedpuri Gate, Darawar Gate, Mori Gate

Type: Historic Gates / Old City | **Double-Decker:** Yes — drive-by | **Ticket:** No entry ticket

These four gateways mark the boundary of Bahawalpur's historic walled city and appear as stops on the reported sightseeing circuit. Individually they are best used as short heritage/photo points or drive-bys rather than long-duration attractions — collectively they're a good opportunity to explain how the old city was organised, entered and connected to its traditional commercial neighbourhoods, especially en route to Noor Mahal, the Museum and the Zoo.

Fawara Chowk

Type: City Landmark | **Double-Decker:** Yes | **Ticket:** No entry ticket

A recognisable urban landmark and route point — best treated as a short orientation or photography stop rather than a destination in its own right.

DAY_TRIP — Beyond the City Core

Not part of the city double-decker loop; each needs its own dedicated excursion.

Sadiq Garh Palace

Type: Palace / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** No — separate trip | **Ticket:** No reliable current public tariff

Located at Dera Nawab Sahib, Sadiq Garh Palace was built in 1874 by Nawab Sadiq Muhammad Khan IV over a ten-year construction period at a cost of about Rs 15 lakh. It had eight residential suites for honoured guests, complete with drawing rooms, dressing rooms and attached baths, plus underground rooms and verandahs on all four sides — serving as the residential headquarters of the last Nawab, who hosted visiting heads of state here until 1975. Its architecture blends European and South Asian influences, reflecting the wealth and ceremonial culture of the former state. Plan it as a separate heritage excursion rather than a city-loop stop, and confirm current access permission before a visit.

Uch Sharif

Type: Heritage / Religious Town | **Double-Decker:** No — separate day trip | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket; shrine rules apply

Uch Sharif is an ancient town believed to date to around 500 BC, roughly 75 km from Bahawalpur; local tradition connects it to Alexander's campaigns in the region. It is one of South Punjab's most important centres of Sufi heritage, home to several historic shrines and distinctive Islamic tomb architecture. Because of the distance and the cultural/religious weight of the site, it is best planned as its own heritage day trip rather than folded into a short city loop.

- **Bibi Jawindi Tomb** — one of Uch Sharif's most recognisable monuments: an octagonal tomb with surviving glazed-tile decoration, an important example of South Punjab's Islamic heritage, well suited to heritage education, architecture observation and photography (subject to site conditions).
- **Jalaluddin Bukhari Tomb** — shrine and tomb forming a key part of Uch Sharif's Sufi heritage; valuable for visitors studying South Punjab's religious history and the development of Sufi centres in the region. Respect visitor conduct and shrine timings.
- **Baha'al-Halim Tomb** — part of the same historic group of Islamic monuments, illustrating the town's role as a centre of religious learning and Sufi culture.
- **Makhdoom Jahaniyan Jahangasht Shrine** — another of the shrine complexes named in connection with Uch Sharif's Sufi heritage landscape.

Panjnad Head

Type: Nature / Geography | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket identified

Panjnad Head marks the meeting point of Punjab's major rivers before they join the Indus, roughly 12 km from Bahawalpur, with a scenic view of the Abbasia Canal island nearby. It works best as a scenic nature and geography stop — particularly good for school groups studying rivers, irrigation and the physical geography of Punjab.

Lal Suhanra National Park

Type: National Park / Nature | **Double-Decker:** No — separate coach/park vehicle | **Ticket:** Verify current tariff

Established in 1972–73 with WWF assistance, Lal Suhanra is unusual for combining desert, forest and wetland environments within one protected area — a wetland zone of roughly 4,780 acres alongside a desert zone of about 18,000 acres, home to blackbuck, chinkara and other regional wildlife. It's a strong destination for wildlife, ecology and family tourism, but conditions at the park and its lake shift seasonally, so show current access, facilities and any park charges as verified information rather than fixed figures.

Bhutta Wahan Shrine

Type: Shrine | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket

A local shrine site roughly 30 km from Bahawalpur, associated with an annual Urs (commemorative gathering).

Musafir Khana Shrine

Type: Shrine | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket

A local shrine site with an annual Urs held in June, per the source brochure.

Bhong Mosque

Type: Mosque / Architecture | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket

Located in Bhong, Rahim Yar Khan District, this mosque won the Aga Khan Award for Architecture in 1986. Construction began in 1932 and took roughly fifty years, completing in 1982 — a notable example of contemporary religious architecture in the region.

CHOLISTAN — The Desert Excursion

Explicitly not a double-decker stop; requires its own desert-capable transport (jeep/coach). This is the multi-fort heritage/adventure circuit.

Cholistan Desert (Rohi)

Type: Nature / Adventure | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** No single standard entry ticket; activity/package prices vary

Cholistan, also called Rohi, is the desert landscape surrounding Bahawalpur's historic fort chain, running along the dried bed of the ancient Hakra River. Tourism here is a different experience from the city circuit — desert landscapes, traditional Cholistani culture, camel rides, camping, and organised safari or rally activities. Because pricing depends on the operator or package rather than a single gate fee, keep entry and activity/package charges shown separately on your platform.

Derawar Fort

Type: Fort / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** Verify current access/permission

Derawar Fort is Cholistan's signature heritage monument. The present fortress has forty large bastions and walls extending roughly 1.5 km, rising dramatically out of the desert. Its history reaches back to the medieval period — originally built around 858 AD by the Hindu Rajput ruler Rai Jajja Bhati — while the Bahawalpur Nawabs, beginning with Nawab Sadeq Muhammad Khan I in 1733, rebuilt and controlled it through the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries; the last Nawab, Sadeq Muhammad Khan V, was born inside the fort in 1904. It is a separate Cholistan excursion, not a city double-decker stop, and current access/permission should always be verified before a group visit.

Abbasi Mosque (Derawar Mosque)

Type: Mosque / Heritage | **Double-Decker:** No — separate trip | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket identified

Standing close to Derawar Fort, the pale-marble Abbasi Mosque is a natural companion stop to the fort and forms part of the same royal Cholistan heritage landscape, with a long historical association with the Bahawalpur rulers. Check mosque etiquette and current access rules before a group visit.

Derawar Cannon

Type: Historic Artefact | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** No standard tourist ticket

A large, locally cast cannon associated with the Cholistan forts, restored and highlighted as part of TDCP's heritage-preservation efforts — the exact date noted on the brochure was not fully legible in the scan, so verify with TDCP before publishing a specific year.

The Remote Fort Network

Type: Fort / Adventure Heritage | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** Verify access for each

These forts are best marketed to heritage and adventure travellers rather than short family city tours — road conditions and access should be checked before planning any group visit.

- **Mir Garh Fort** — built by Rawal Bhim Singh in 1608 AD, deep in Cholistan near the Indian border.
- **Islamgarh Fort** — associated with the 1805–1954 period (brochure detail partially illegible; verify wording with TDCP).
- **Din Garh (Dingarh) Fort** — built 1768 AD by Nawab Muhammad Mubarak Khan Abbasi, on the site of the older ruined town of Tarhata.
- **Khangarh (Khan Garh) Fort** — built 1783 AD by Nawab Muhammad Bahawal Khan II; square plan, semi-circular corner bastions.
- **Phoolra Fort** — built 1754 AD by Nawab Muhammad Mubarak Khan Abbasi, near Fort Abbas; extensively ruined.
- **Liara Fort** — built 1780 AD by Sujan Khan; an almost-square mud-brick fort.
- **Bijnot (Bhijnot) Fort** — one of the oldest in the network, built 757 AD by Raja Bhatia; structurally impressive despite being in ruins.
- **Nawankot Fort** — built 1739 AD by Amir Muhammad Bahawal Khan Abbasi, about 70 km from Derawar.
- **Khairgarh Fort** — built 1775 AD, mud-brick, roughly 170 feet square, about 70 km from Derawar; now mostly collapsed.
- **Jamgarh Fort** — pre-Islamic origin, refortified in later centuries.
- **Marot Fort** — an important outpost since at least the 12th century; the historian Minhaj-i-Siraj recorded visiting it in 1250 AD, and a Mughal-era garrison of roughly 200 horsemen and 1000 infantry was once stationed here.
- **Moujgarh (Mojgarh) Fort** — built 1743 AD, with a glazed-tile tomb about 400 yards south of the fort, roughly 32 km from Mirgarh.

Cholistan Desert Jeep Rally

Type: Event | **Double-Decker:** No | **Ticket:** N/A — event, not a ticketed site

TDCP's annual jeep rally, held every February, is designed to promote Cholistan's cultural and historical heritage and draws visitors from across Pakistan and abroad. It's accompanied by cultural shows, fireworks and a camel show. Exact dates shift year to year — pull the current calendar from TDCP rather than fixing a date on your platform.

Camel Safari / Jeep Safari / Desert Camping

Type: Activity | **Location:** Derawar / Cholistan Desert

Derawar Fort is the best starting point for camel safaris into the desert, with guides and camels available on site; jeep safaris and overnight or evening camping trips can also be arranged to explore the desert's rugged terrain and ancient heritage. Durations and prices were not specified in any source material — confirm with TDCP or the relevant operator.

DHA_MODERN_CITY

DHA Bahawalpur

Type: Modern City / Recreation | **Double-Decker:** Yes for the main-road approach; verify individual stops | **Ticket:** Road access is not a tourist ticket; individual venues vary

DHA Bahawalpur represents the modern, planned side of the city and should be offered as a separate modern-city drive rather than folded into the historical sightseeing route. Its planned boulevards, parks, commercial areas and recreational facilities give families and school groups a different kind of experience from the Nawabi-heritage circuit. Exact vehicle stopping points, security requirements and group permissions should be verified directly with DHA before building a fixed itinerary around it.

Sourcing Note

This document consolidates three source materials: the TDCP Cholistan brochure, the TDCP Bahawalpur City / Attractions-Around brochure, and the paragraph-form reference PDF that introduced the INSIDE_CITY / DAY_TRIP / CHOLISTAN / DHA_MODERN_CITY routing rule and the reported Zoo tariff. Facts for Derawar Fort and Noor Mahal were independently cross-checked against outside sources and hold up well; a handful of Cholistan fort panels were partially illegible in the original photographed brochure and are flagged inline above. Nothing here should be treated as a final, live price — every "verify" note is intentional, not a placeholder to be filled with a guess.